



The shearer shears the sheep so that the fleece comes off in one piece.

Bathtime

Once or twice a year, the farmer drives the sheep through a chemical dip. This keeps them free of pests and diseases.



Mummy!

Some lambs are orphaned or not wanted by their mother. These may be bottle-fed by the farmer or shepherd, or adopted by another ewe.

Working dogs

Dogs are used to gather the sheep in flocks and move them from place to place. Sheepdogs naturally like to herd animals, but they need to be trained to follow instructions. The shepherd controls the dog using

special calls and whistles.

Sheep are timid, so the dog will run low in the grass to avoid frightening them.



In a spin

To produce wool for knitting or weaving, many strands are twisted together to make one long thread. Spinning was first done by hand using a spindle. Later, the spindle was attached to a wheel, and wool could be spun more quickly. Now, most spinning is done by machine.



Domestic sheep



Suffolk



Wensleydale



Karakul



Scottish blackface

Wild sheep



Bighorn